Minister Dr S. Jaishankar to take a final decision on evacuation. On 25 January, Principal Secretary Dr Mishra convened a high-level meeting to discuss and finalize details on evacuation. This meeting was attended by the Cabinet secretary, secretary of Home Affairs, secretary of External Affairs, secretary of Defence, secretary of Health and Family Welfare and secretary of Civil Aviation.[26] By the next day, 26 January, they had confirmed information from WeChat, a WhatsApp-equivalent mobile application used in China, that out of all the Indians who were contacted, about 750 wanted to return to India. The others wanted to either stay put or travel to different parts of the country. Half of those who wanted to return lived in deeper areas of the Hubei province and the other half of them in Wuhan. The decision to evacuate wasn't easy. The prime minister was aware that many countries had decided against taking out their citizens from China, mainly because of the fear that they wouldn't want to provide an opportunity for an unknown virus to spread in their countries. Pakistan, for instance, had already announced that they will not take their citizens back. In fact, their envoy had said, 'Students should stay in Wuhan as Pakistan cannot treat coronavirus.'[27] The prime minister was certain though, if there were Indian citizens who felt unsafe and sought to return home, India should enable their homecoming, no matter how large a risk it was. He gave his go-ahead to evacuate Indians and instructed the officers to begin making all required preparations. The PMO then effectively advised all concerned bureaucrats to work out the logistics and prepare to evacuate on short notice. Simultaneously, negotiations regarding evacuations were ongoing, as natural for any other country; China's stand was that it would keep people safe. At this point, no other country had evacuated its citizens from China; however, Vietnam, which had suspended all flights[28] to and from Wuhan, permitted special flights between 23 and 27 January to bring back stranded citizens. However, many countries were in talks with the Chinese authorities seeking permission to be allowed to extradite their citizens. On 28 January, even as Misri and the deputy chief of mission worked to obtain clearances, the outgoing secretary of External Affairs, Gokhale with his incumbent, Harsh Vardhan Shringla worked closely with the Ministry of Civil Aviation, Air India (our national airline carrier), the Bureau of Immigration and the Indian Army. Air India was asked to put together two aircrafts and an experienced crew on standby, whereas the Indian Army was to set up quarantine facilities for the returnees.